

Server and Application Deployment & Security Documentation

Overview

As part of a comprehensive effort to secure and stabilize our Laravel-based application, the following actions were undertaken:

- The older, potentially compromised or outdated droplet was **completely destroyed**.
 - A **new DigitalOcean droplet** was created with a fresh environment and server configuration.
 - The **entire Laravel project**, including the database and associated services, was **re-implemented** on the new server.
 - The **domain and subdomains** were mapped and configured again.
 - The **admin panel subdomain** was **salted and blocked from being indexed** by Google and other search engines to prevent unauthorized exposure.
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Server-Level Security Measures

1. Cloudflare IP Masking

- Cloudflare was configured as a reverse proxy for the server.
- Direct IP access was blocked; all incoming requests are routed through Cloudflare.
- This protects the origin server from DDoS attacks and hides its real IP.

2. Fail2Ban Configuration

- Fail2Ban was installed and configured to monitor failed login attempts.
- Automatically bans IPs that exceed the allowed number of failed authentication attempts.